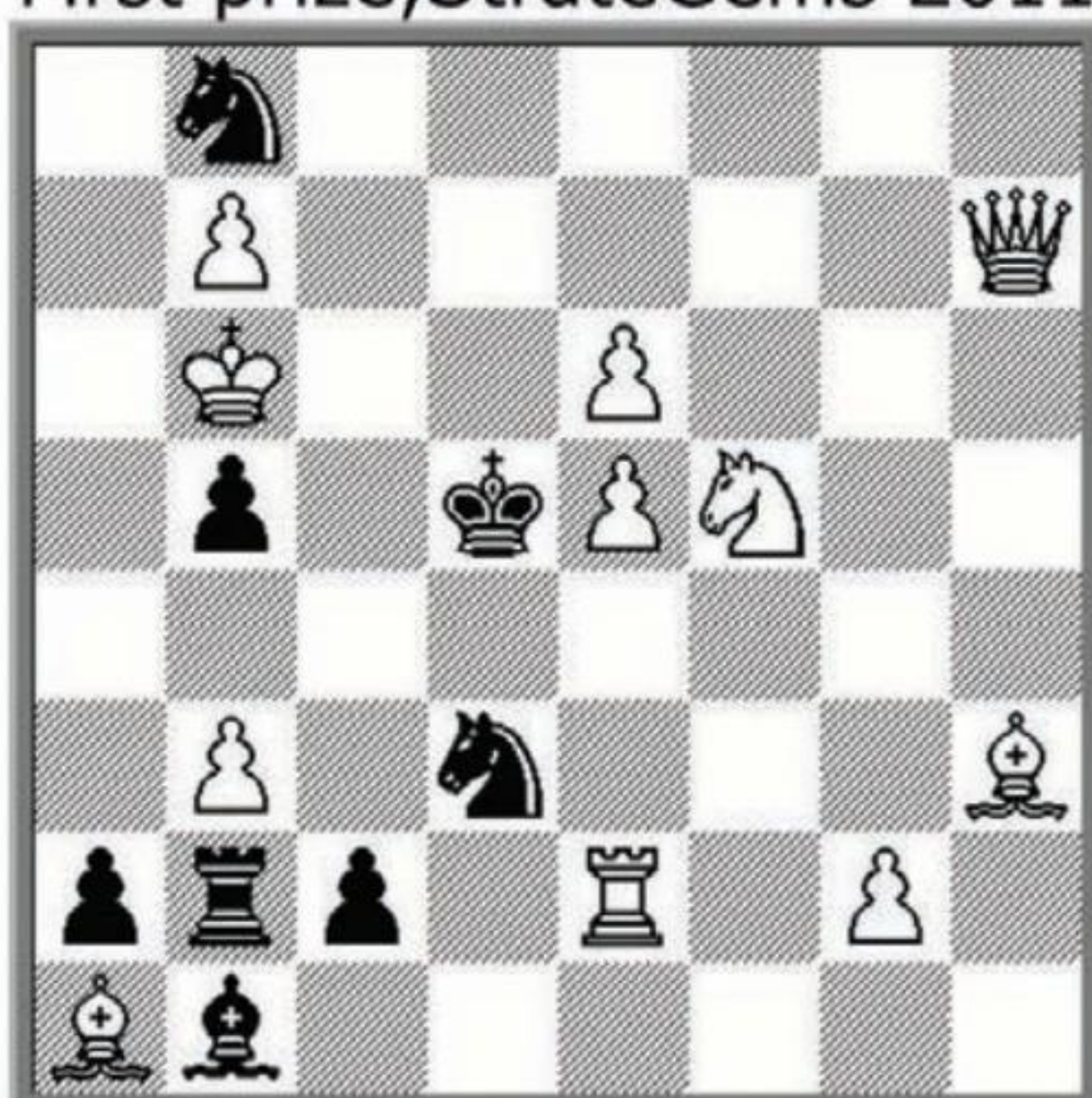


Reciprocal change of mates

By C.G.S.Narayanan

Reversal of mate or continuation for two black defences over two phases is termed 'Reciprocal change' in problem parlance. It is a popular two-move theme extended to three-move as well where the second move continuations after two black moves are exchanged. Hundreds of problems on this pattern theme have been composed over the years using highly original schemes. In this article we would look at three two-movers with reversal effect where one of the two defences is a black king flight. In the first diagram below shows how the reciprocal theme relate set play to actual play.

C.G.S.Narayanan
First prize, StrateGems 2011



Mate in two move

The two black defences to watch are 1...Rxb3 and 1...Kxe6 and the set play runs like this. 1...Rxb3 2.Ne3 (A) and 1...Kxe6 2.Ne7 (B). After the **key 1.Qc7!** the threat is 2.Qd6 1...Rxb3 2.Ne7 (B) and 1...Kxe6 2.Ne3 (A) not 2.Ne7 as f7 guard will be lost.

Let us study as to how the reversal of mates take place after key. In the set 1...Rxb3 eliminates guard of c4 and so 2.Ne3 has to cover this square. After the key 1...Rxb3 is met by 2.Ne7 opening up the masked battery to cover d5. Here 2.Ne3

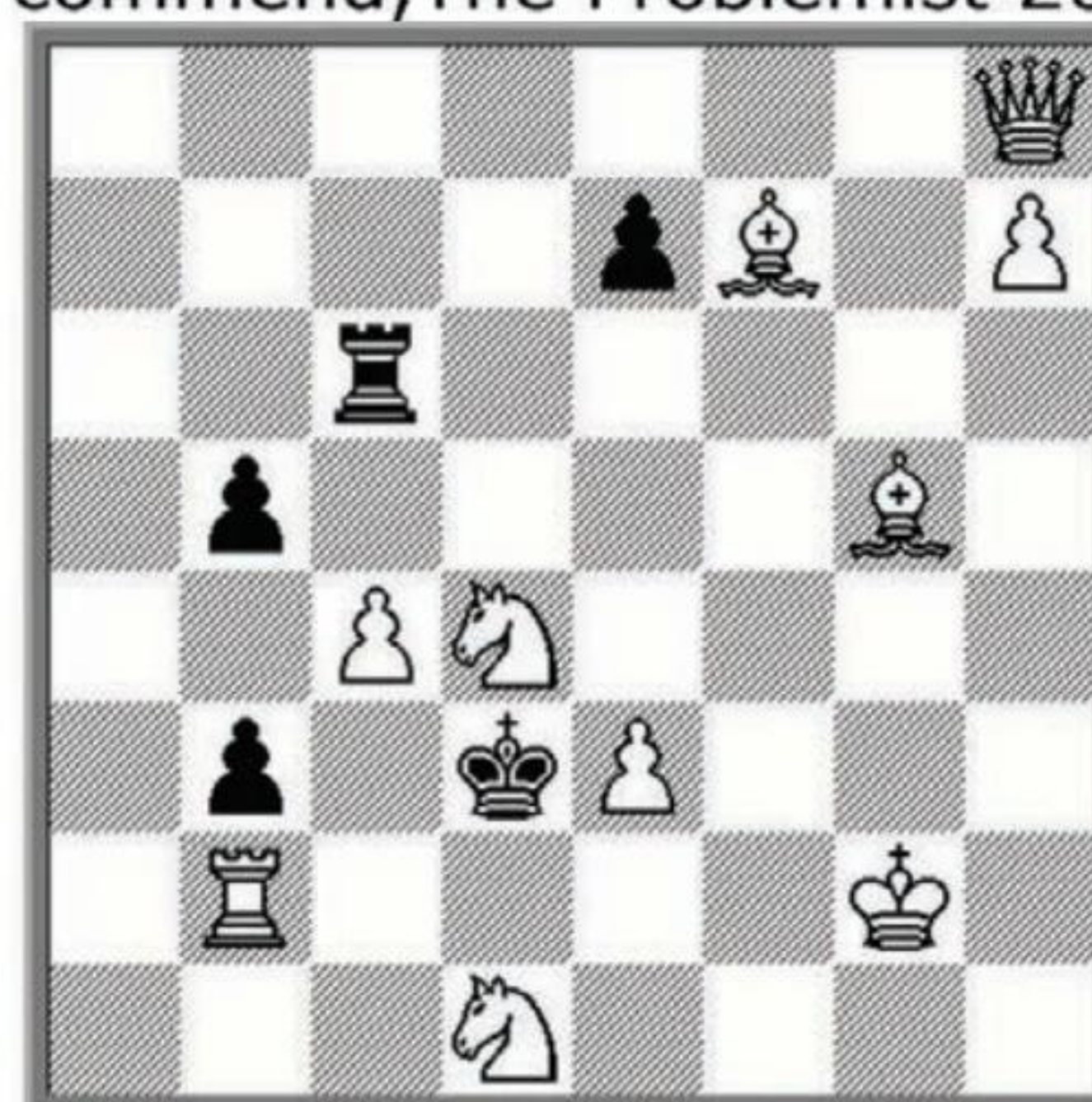
cannot be played as guard for e4 is lost.

The second two-mover has some embellishments- a flight giving key and opening and closing BR line.

Set: 1...Rxc4 (self-block on c4) 2.Bg6 (A); 1...Ke4 2.Nf2 (B) **Key 1.Ne6** (threat 2.Qd4/Nf4) 1...Rxc4 2.Nf2 (B) and 1...Bg6 (A) (WN closes the sixth rank) and the by-play 1...Kxc4 2.Qd4; 1...Rd6 2.Nc5

C.G.S.Narayanan

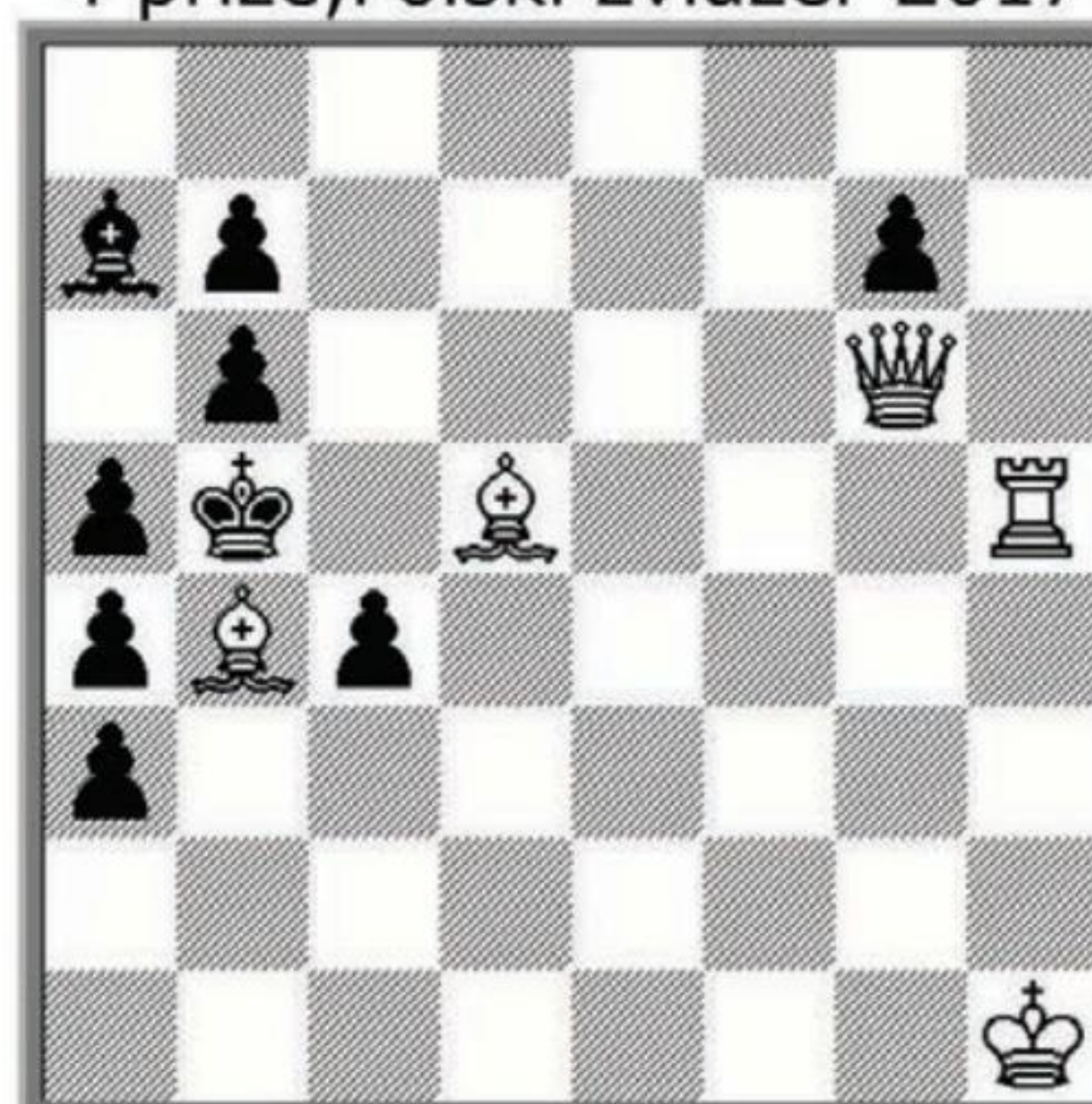
3 commend, The Problemist 2011



Mate in two move

The problem for solving below shows reciprocal change for the defences Ka6 and axb4 from set to key.

C.G.S.Narayanan
4 prize, Polski zviazer 2017



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'On solving three-movers'

Key 1.Qb2! zugzwang Nice retreating key 1...Kd7 2.Qe5 waiting (2...Kc6 3.Qd5; 2...Kc8 3.Qc7

Readers may send in their queries to
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